English Orbit

PART 5 OF 6 / B2

Upper-intermediate

Discuss ideas, weigh evidence and express nuanced opinions.

Read. Listen. Write. Speak. Understand.

An original coursebook companion to the interactive English Orbit course. Four connected lessons combine language explanations with practical activities and guided review.

Included in this part: language focus, vocabulary, reading passages, grammar practice, listening scripts, speaking tasks, writing tasks, a level checkpoint and answer keys.

For independent learners, classrooms and teacher-led study. All teaching content is in English.

Use the course alongside the book

Open English Orbit to hear lesson passages and model sentences. Select this level and the matching lesson.

CEFR labels indicate the intended language focus. This compact companion is not a complete CEFR syllabus or an official proficiency qualification.

Your route through this part

Discuss ideas, weigh evidence and express nuanced opinions.

Four lessons, one clear sequence

01 The attention economy | Argument & contrast

02 A different outcome | Third conditional & reflection

03 Evidence or impression? | Hedging & evaluating claims

04 Negotiating a solution | Polite disagreement & proposals

How to study a lesson

1. Read for the overall meaning. Read again and notice the language focus.
2. Learn the four key words. Make your own example for each word.
3. Complete the reading and grammar practice before checking the answers.
4. Listen without reading first. Write a dictation, then compare it with the script.
5. Speak aloud, record if possible, and reflect on your delivery.
6. Write a response, review it and revise at least one sentence.

> Suggested rhythm: 25-40 minutes in the app, plus 20-30 minutes of book practice per lesson. Take breaks and repeat difficult activities rather than rushing to the next level.

Use a notebook for extended answers. Listening can use the app, a teacher or a study partner. The PDF contains scripts and tasks; it does not contain embedded audio.

For open questions, wording may differ from the sample answers. For speaking and writing, use the review criteria; there is no single correct personal response.

The attention economy

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Argument & contrast

01 / Read and notice

Digital platforms compete for our attention. Notifications can help us stay informed, yet they also interrupt deep work. Some researchers argue that switching between tasks carries a hidden cost: we need time to regain focus. Nevertheless, removing every notification is not always practical. A more balanced approach is to decide which messages deserve immediate attention and check the rest at planned intervals.

Language focus

Use contrast markers precisely: yet introduces a contrast; nevertheless acknowledges a difficulty while continuing an argument. Distinguish a claim from the supporting reason. The recommendation is a compromise, not a complete ban.

Key words

regain - get back

interval - a period between events

selectively - by choosing some rather than all

interrupt - stop something briefly

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

The attention economy

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Which position best matches the writer's view?

A. All notifications should be removed / B. Every message needs an immediate response / C. Manage notifications selectively

2. What is the hidden cost of switching tasks?

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3. Why does the writer reject a complete ban?

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03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: yet / intervals / Nevertheless / regain / balanced

1. Notifications help, _____ they interrupt work.

2. _____, removing every notification is impractical.

3. The recommendation is a _____ approach.

4. We need time to _____ focus.

5. Check non-urgent messages at planned _____.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

The attention economy

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> Although notifications can be useful, they may interrupt deep work.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 60-90 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 150-180 words arguing for a practical way to manage digital distractions. Address one counterargument.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

A different outcome

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Third conditional & reflection

01 / Read and notice

The organisers expected three hundred guests, but nearly five hundred arrived. As a result, the food ran out early. If they had checked registrations more carefully, they would have ordered enough. They could also have arranged a backup supplier. Rather than blame individuals, the team agreed to improve its planning process before the next event.

Language focus

Third conditional: if + had + past participle, would have + past participle. It imagines a different past. Could have describes a past possibility. Reflection can identify improvements without assigning personal blame.

Key words

registration - a record of signing up

supplier - a provider of goods

backup - an alternative for emergencies

blame - hold responsible for a mistake

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

A different outcome

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

What is implied about registration checks?

A. They were sufficiently careful / B. They could have been more careful / C. They were impossible

2. How many guests arrived compared with the estimate?

3. What did the team decide to improve?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: had checked / have arranged / would have ordered / ran out / past

1. If they _____ registrations, they would have ordered more.

2. They _____ more if they had checked.

3. They could _____ a backup supplier.

4. The food _____ before everyone ate.

5. The third conditional imagines a different _____.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

A different outcome

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> If they had checked registrations, they would have ordered enough food.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 60-90 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 150-180 words reflecting on a past decision, real or fictional. Include two unreal past alternatives and a future lesson.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Evidence or impression?

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Hedging & evaluating claims

01 / Read and notice

A small survey found that employees who worked from home reported greater satisfaction. This may suggest a benefit, but the result should be interpreted cautiously. Participants chose to answer the survey, and most worked in technology. The findings therefore cannot automatically be applied to every profession. A larger, more representative study would help clarify the relationship.

Language focus

Hedging avoids claiming more than evidence supports: may suggest, appears to, is likely to. Evaluate sample size, selection and representativeness. A reported association does not by itself establish causation.

Key words

representative - reflecting the wider group

finding - a research result

cautiously - with care

association - a relationship between things

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Evidence or impression?

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

What limits the survey's generalisability?

A. Its participants were not representative of every profession / B. It included no employees / C. It measured nothing

2. Why might the sample be biased?

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3. What kind of study would help?

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03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: causation / technology / representative / may suggest / cautiously

1. The results _____ a benefit, not prove it.

2. Interpret the findings _____.

3. The sample was not _____ of every profession.

4. An association does not establish _____.

5. Most participants worked in _____.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Evidence or impression?

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> The findings may suggest a benefit, but they should be interpreted cautiously.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 60-90 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 150-180 words evaluating a fictional survey. Include two limitations and carefully qualified conclusions.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Negotiating a solution

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Polite disagreement & proposals

01 / Read and notice

A client wants the new website delivered a week early. The designer explains that this would leave too little time for testing. "I understand why the date matters," she says. "Would you be open to launching the core pages first?" The client agrees, provided that the remaining pages follow within two weeks. Both sides confirm the revised scope in writing.

Language focus

Acknowledge a concern before presenting an alternative. Would you be open to + -ing is a tactful proposal. Provided that introduces a condition. Confirm scope and timing to avoid ambiguous agreements.

Key words

scope - the agreed extent of work

provided that - only if

core - most essential

tactful - careful about others' feelings

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Negotiating a solution

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

What compromise do they reach?

A. Cancel the website / B. Launch the core pages before the remaining pages / C. Skip all testing

2. Why is an early launch difficult?

3. When must the remaining pages follow?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: provided that / acknowledges / scope / only if / launching

1. Would you be open to _____ the core pages first?

2. The client agrees _____ other pages follow.

3. Both sides confirm the revised _____.

4. The designer _____ why the date matters.

5. Provided that means _____.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Negotiating a solution

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> Would you be open to launching the core pages first?

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 60-90 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write a 150-180 word professional email negotiating a deadline. Acknowledge the request, propose an alternative and specify conditions.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Level checkpoint / 1 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

01. Which position best matches the writer's view?

A. All notifications should be removed

B. Every message needs an immediate response

C. Manage notifications selectively

Reading reference: Lesson 1, The attention economy

02. Which introduces a contrast?

A. Therefore

B. Nevertheless

C. As a result

Language focus review

03. What is implied about registration checks?

A. They were sufficiently careful

B. They could have been more careful

C. They were impossible

Reading reference: Lesson 2, A different outcome

04. Complete: If they had checked, they ___ enough food.

A. would have ordered

B. will order

C. would ordered

Language focus review

Level checkpoint / 2 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

05. What limits the survey's generalisability?

A. Its participants were not representative of every profession

B. It included no employees

C. It measured nothing

Reading reference: Lesson 3, Evidence or impression?

06. Which is appropriately cautious?

A. This proves everyone benefits.

B. Every profession must benefit.

C. This may suggest a benefit.

Language focus review

07. What compromise do they reach?

A. Cancel the website

B. Launch the core pages before the remaining pages

C. Skip all testing

Reading reference: Lesson 4, Negotiating a solution

08. "Provided that" means…

A. because

B. only if

C. even though

Language focus review

Answer key / 1 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 1 / The attention economy

Reading 1: C. Manage notifications selectively. The writer recognises their usefulness, then recommends prioritising messages and checking others at intervals.

Reading 2: Time needed to regain focus.

Reading 3: Removing every notification is not always practical.

Language practice: 1. yet; 2. Nevertheless; 3. balanced; 4. regain; 5. intervals

Dictation: Digital platforms compete for our attention.

Lesson 2 / A different outcome

Reading 1: B. They could have been more careful. The unreal past condition suggests the checks were not careful enough in reality.

Reading 2: Nearly 500 arrived; 300 were expected.

Reading 3: Its planning process rather than blaming individuals.

Language practice: 1. had checked; 2. would have ordered; 3. have arranged; 4. ran out; 5. past

Dictation: The organisers expected three hundred guests, but nearly five hundred arrived.

Checkpoint answers

1. C: The writer recognises their usefulness, then recommends prioritising messages and checking others at intervals.
2. B: Nevertheless introduces a contrasting point despite the previous one.

3. B: The unreal past condition suggests the checks were not careful enough in reality.
4. A: The third conditional uses would have + past participle.

Answer key / 2 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 3 / Evidence or impression?

Reading 1: A. Its participants were not representative of every profession. Most respondents worked in technology and chose to respond, so the sample may not reflect other professions.

Reading 2: People chose to respond, and most worked in technology.

Reading 3: A larger and more representative study.

Language practice: 1. may suggest; 2. cautiously; 3. representative; 4. causation; 5. technology

Dictation: A small survey found that employees who worked from home reported greater satisfaction.

Lesson 4 / Negotiating a solution

Reading 1: B. Launch the core pages before the remaining pages. They agree to a staged launch with the remaining pages following within two weeks.

Reading 2: It leaves too little time for testing.

Reading 3: Within two weeks.

Language practice: 1. launching; 2. provided that; 3. scope; 4. acknowledges; 5. only if

Dictation: A client wants the new website delivered a week early.

Checkpoint answers

5. A: Most respondents worked in technology and chose to respond, so the sample may not reflect other professions.
6. C: May suggest qualifies the conclusion.

7. B: They agree to a staged launch with the remaining pages following within two weeks.
8. B: Provided that introduces a condition.

Review and continue

Use evidence of practice, not just a score.

Writing review

There is no single correct response to a personal writing prompt. Use this four-part review and ask a teacher or partner for feedback when possible.

Task - My response answers the prompt and gives relevant examples.

Language - I attempted the target structure and checked verb forms and word order.

Organisation - Ideas follow a clear order. At higher levels, claims have support and qualifications.

Revision - I improved one sentence after rereading or receiving feedback.

Speaking review

Focus on intelligibility, appropriate vocabulary, complete ideas and natural pauses. At Starter, short clear phrases are enough. At Advanced, support a position, respond to alternatives and choose an appropriate register.

After your checkpoint

6-8 correct: continue if the productive tasks also feel manageable.
0-5 correct: revisit the language explanations and try new examples before retaking the check.

A strong multiple-choice score alone does not demonstrate writing or speaking proficiency. Keep a portfolio of drafts and recordings.

Next step: Advanced - Interpret complex arguments and communicate with precision.